



University center Abdelhafid Boussouf - Mila
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E-Learning unit

English - level 1

– Lesson 6 – English Adverbs

Staff pédagogique

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Etudiants concernés

Institut	Département	Année	Spécialité
-Lettres et Langues étrangères	- Français	-Français	Licence 1
-Sciences et Techniques	-MI- ST	-MI- ST	Licence 1
-Sciences Economique	-SE	-Toutes les spécialités	Licence 1

Objectives of lesson 6

- i. To make students aware of the use of adverbs in a sentence;
- ii. To familiarize students with different kinds adverbs.

1. Definition:

An **adverb** is a word that modifies verbs, adjectives and other adverbs.

Adverbs vs. Adjectives

The difference between an adverb and an adjective is the following:

- An adjective modifies a noun.

Example:

"John is **tall**." (The adjective **tall** modifies the noun **John**)

- An adverb modifies a verb, an adjective or another adverb.

Examples:

"That idea is **simply** ridiculous." (The adverb **simply** modifies the adjective **ridiculous**)

"She sings **nicely**." (The adverb **nicely** modifies the verb **sing**)

"She did it **really** well." (the adverb **really** modifies the adverb **well**)

2. Types of Adverbs

There are different kinds of adverbs expressing different meanings. The following are some of the common ones.

2.1. Adverbs of Time

Adverbs of Time tell us something about the time when something happens. Adverbs of time include, **already**, **immediately**, **last month**, **now**, **soon**, **then**, and **yesterday**.

They can answer the question "when?"

- He *came* **yesterday**. (When did he come?)
- I *want* it **now**. (When do I want it?)
- **Last week**, we were stuck in the lift for an hour (When did you get stuck in the lift?)

2.2. Adverbs of Place

Adverbs of Place tell us about the place where something happens. They answer the question "where?". Adverbs of place include words such as **above**, **below**, **here**, **outside**, **over there**, **there**, **under**, **upstairs**

- Please *sit* **here**. (Where should I sit?)
- They *looked* **everywhere**. (Where did they look?)
- Two cars were *parked* **outside**. (Where were two cars parked?)

2.3. Adverb of Manner

Adverbs of manner tell us the manner or way in which something happens. They answer the question "how? Adverbs of manner are words such as **badly, happily, sadly, slowly, quickly**, and others that include **well, hard, fast**. (We can usually use wh-questions starting with **how** when we want to know what adverb of manner has been used)

- He *speaks* **slowly**. (How does he speak?)
- They *helped* us **cheerfully**. (How did they help us?)
- James Bond *drives* his cars **fast**. (How does James Bond drive his cars?)

2.4. Adverbs of Degree

Adverbs of degree tell us the degree or extent to which something happens. They answer the question "how much?" or "to what degree?". Adverbs of Degree can modify *verbs, adjectives* and other *adverbs*. This category includes: **almost, much, nearly, quite, really, too, very**, etc.

- She **entirely** *agrees* with him. (How much does she agree with him?)
- Mary is **very** *beautiful*. (To what degree is Mary beautiful? How beautiful is Mary?)
- He drove **quite** *dangerously*. (To what degree did he drive dangerously? How dangerously did he drive?)

2.5. Adverb of Frequency

An adverb of frequency tells us how often something is done or happens. Adverbs of frequency include **again, almost, always, ever, frequently, generally, hardly ever, nearly, nearly always, never, occasionally, often, rarely, seldom, sometimes, twice, usually, and weekly**.

Frequency	Adverb of Frequency	Example Sentence
100%	always	I always go to bed before 11 p.m.
90%	usually	I usually have cereal for breakfast.
80%	normally / generally	I normally go to the gym.
70%	often* / frequently	I often surf the internet.
50%	sometimes	I sometimes forget my wife's birthday.
30%	occasionally	I occasionally eat junk food.
10%	seldom	I seldom read the newspaper.
5%	rarely	I rarely drink alcohol.

0%	never	I never swim in the sea.
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Time for Practice:

a. Find the adjective in the first sentence and fill the gap with the adverb.

1. Joanne is happy. She smiles happily
2. The boy is loud. He shouts.....
3. Her English is fluent. She speaks English.....
4. Our mum was angry. She spoke to us.....
5. My neighbour is a careless driver. He drives

b. Complete the sentences using an adverb or an adjective.

1. He's always in a rush. I don't understand why he walks so _____ (quick/quickly).
2. I prefer studying in the library. It's always _____ (quiet/quietly).
3. Michael _____ (happy/happily) took the assistant job. He had been looking for a position all summer.
4. Marta dances _____ (beautiful/beautifully). She's been taking ballet since she was five years old.
5. They speak French very _____ (good/well). They lived in France for two years.
6. My neighbor always plays _____ (loud/loudly) music on the weekends. It's so annoying.

References

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- 4) Murdphy. R. (2012). English Grammar in Use. Cambridge. Cambridge University Press.
- 5) Chalker. S. (1992). A Student's English Grammar. Longman: England*.